

# Performance Review Guidelines

Human Resources | Effective January 1, 2025

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## Overview

FreeTime AI conducts formal performance reviews twice per year - in June (mid-year) and December (year-end). The goal of this process is to support employee growth, recognize strong contributions, and align individual performance with company objectives. This document outlines the process, rating scale, and expectations for both employees and managers.

## Review Schedule

### Mid-Year Review (June)

The mid-year review is a progress check. Employees and managers assess goal progress, identify blockers, and adjust priorities for the second half of the year. Ratings at mid-year are advisory and do not directly affect compensation.

- Self-assessment due: June 1
- Manager review period: June 2-14
- One-on-one review meetings: June 15-30

### Year-End Review (December)

The year-end review is a comprehensive evaluation covering the full calendar year. Ratings from this review inform compensation adjustments, promotion decisions, and performance improvement plans.

- Self-assessment due: December 1
- Manager review period: December 2-14
- One-on-one review meetings: December 15-22
- Compensation decisions communicated: January 15

## Rating Scale

All employees are rated on a 5-point scale across two dimensions: Goal Achievement and Core Competencies. Final ratings are a holistic assessment, not a mathematical average.

### 5 - Exceptional

Consistently exceeds all expectations. Delivers outsized impact and raises the bar for the team.

### 4 - Exceeds Expectations

Regularly goes beyond what is required. Strong contributor with clear positive impact.

### 3 - Meets Expectations

Reliably delivers on goals and demonstrates expected competencies. Solid, dependable performance.

## 2 - Developing

Partially meets expectations. Some goals achieved but notable gaps remain. A development plan will be established.

## 1 - Below Expectations

Does not meet expectations. A formal performance improvement plan (PIP) is required.

## Core Competencies

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In addition to goal outcomes, all employees are evaluated on five core competencies:

- Communication - Clarity, transparency, and effectiveness across written and verbal channels.
- Collaboration - Working effectively with teammates, cross-functional partners, and stakeholders.
- Ownership - Taking responsibility for outcomes, following through, and solving problems proactively.
- Growth Mindset - Seeking feedback, learning from setbacks, and continuously developing skills.
- Impact - Producing work that meaningfully advances team or company goals.

## Self-Assessment Guidelines

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Self-assessments should be honest, specific, and evidence-based. Avoid vague language. For each goal, describe what you accomplished, how you measured success, and what you would do differently. For competencies, provide one or two concrete examples.

Self-assessments are shared with your manager before the review meeting and form the basis for a two-way conversation, not a one-directional evaluation.

## Manager Responsibilities

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- Complete written evaluations for each direct report within the designated review window.
- Calibrate ratings with peer managers before delivering feedback to ensure consistency.
- Conduct review meetings in a private, distraction-free setting.
- Provide specific, actionable feedback - both recognition and areas for growth.
- Document agreed development actions and follow up at the next 1:1.

## Promotion Considerations

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A year-end rating of 4 or 5 for two consecutive cycles, combined with demonstrated readiness for the next level, makes an employee eligible for promotion consideration. Promotions are not guaranteed by rating alone - they require a role need and manager advocacy. Employees interested in promotion should discuss this explicitly with their manager at the mid-year review.

## Questions

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Contact the People team at [hr@getfreetime.ai](mailto:hr@getfreetime.ai) with any questions about the review process.